

VERSION 1.0 - PRODUCTION CANDIDATE

# French Workbook

## Français

Writing and pronunciation foundations, core grammar, 1,000 audited vocabulary entries, and 1,000 curated bilingual practice sentences with handwriting and retrieval space.

### **Foundations**

Natural, idiomatic learner language takes priority over artificial uniqueness. Genuine homographs are retained when their learner meaning and grammatical role differ. A source-backed pronunciation key is taught in Foundations; sentence drills then use normal target-language spelling rather than inconsistent ad-hoc romanization.

# Foundations

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Target register: contemporary standard French. These pages orient deliberate practice; the vocabulary and sentence sections provide the bulk of retrieval work.

## Script / alphabet reference

**A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z**

Use this as a compact reference, then practice connected words rather than isolated shapes alone.

## Numbers 0-10

**0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10**

**zéro · un · deux · trois · quatre · cinq · six · sept · huit  
· neuf · dix**

## Articles and gender

French nouns have grammatical gender. Learn a noun with its article whenever practical because article and adjective forms depend on gender and number.

## Agreement

Many adjectives and past participles change form according to gender and number. Do not infer pronunciation changes from spelling changes automatically.

## Verb system

High-frequency verbs are often irregular. Learn common present forms early, then build passé composé, imperfect, future, and conditional patterns around real sentences.

## Negation

Standard written French commonly uses *ne ... pas* around a finite verb. In informal speech, *ne* is often omitted, but the workbook keeps standard forms unless a source sentence naturally reflects conversational usage.

## Questions

Questions can use intonation, *est-ce que*, or inversion. Register and context determine which sounds most natural.

## Pronouns

Object pronouns normally appear before the finite verb. Their order is fixed, so learn common combinations as chunks rather than translating word by word.

## Handwriting warm-up

Copy five useful words from today's lesson, then write them again from memory.

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## Pronunciation quick-start

Broad contemporary standard/Metropolitan French reference pronunciation. The guide highlights contrasts that commonly cause beginner errors and explicitly marks features that vary by region, register, or speech rate.

**Notation:** slashes // show broad IPA phonemes or practical reference targets. They are more precise than English respellings but still do not encode every accent or connected-speech detail.

## **u versus ou**

**u /y/ · ou /u/**

Keep these vowels distinct. For /y/, hold the tongue near the position for /i/ while rounding the lips; /u/ is a back rounded vowel.

## **Nasal vowels**

**sans /sɑ̃/ · son /sɔ̃/ · pain /pɛ̃/ · un /œ̃/**

These are broad reference examples. Many speakers merge /œ̃/ with /ɛ̃/, and spelling-to-sound patterns have lexical exceptions, so do not generalize from letters alone.

## **French r**

**r /ʀ/**

A common standard reference target is uvular. Its exact phonetic realization can range from approximant-like to fricative or trill-like across speakers and contexts.

## **Schwa**

**e /ə/ in some contexts**

Schwa may be pronounced or omitted depending on the word, rhythm, register, and surrounding sounds. Not every written e represents /ə/.

## **Word-final consonants**

**often silent, but lexical**

Many final consonant letters are not pronounced, but there are important word-specific exceptions. Learn the pronunciation with the lexical item instead of applying a blanket deletion rule.

## **Liaison**

### **latent final consonant + following vowel sound**

In appropriate grammatical contexts a normally silent final consonant can surface before a following vowel sound. Liaison can be obligatory, optional, or forbidden; it is not triggered mechanically before every vowel-initial word.

## **Elision**

### **j'aime · l'ami**

Certain short function words lose a final vowel before a following vowel sound or mute h, and the apostrophe marks the elision in writing.

## **Rhythm**

### **phrase/rhythm-group prominence**

French does not use English-style fixed lexical stress on each content word. Prominence tends to fall near the end of a rhythm group, with phrasing and speech style affecting the result.

## **Three-step pronunciation routine**

1. Mark /y/ versus /u/, nasal vowels, and any liaison or elision before reading a phrase aloud.
2. Read in short rhythm groups rather than stressing each content word as though it were English.
3. Use the IPA as a broad target and confirm unfamiliar lexical exceptions rather than inventing pronunciations from spelling alone.

Sentence drills intentionally stay in normal target-language spelling: the pronunciation key supports decoding without creating dependence on ad-hoc romanization.

# Sources, licensing, and QA scope

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**Vocabulary:** drawn from this repository's canonical audited top-1,000 deck for the language. Repository source and audit records remain the source of truth.

**Arabic and French sentences:** quality-filtered from the ManyThings bilingual exports of the Tatoeba Project, with supplied sentence-level attribution retained under CC BY 2.0 France.

**Urdu sentences:** original controlled standard-Urdu learner sentences authored for this workbook from reviewed grammar-safe conversation families. They replace a rejected external candidate corpus that failed the release linguistic audit.

**Quality scope:** release gates check canonical dataset integrity, row counts, duplicate handling, script plausibility, sentence-type balance, source diversity where applicable, blocked Urdu legacy-error patterns, PDF structure, font embedding, and renderability. These checks materially reduce risk but do not substitute for independent native-speaker editorial certification; no absolute error-free claim is made.

**Pronunciation foundations:** broad-IPA and articulatory guidance was cross-checked against Karin C. Ryding, *A Reference Grammar of Modern Standard Arabic* (Cambridge University Press); Bernard Tranel, *The Sounds of French: An Introduction* (Cambridge University Press); Saleem et al., *Urdu Consonantal and Vocalic Sounds* (CRULP / Center for Language Engineering); and the Omniglot Urdu-script reference for Nastaliq, nūn ghunnah, and aspirated-letter conventions. These are broad learner reference targets, not a claim that each language has one accent-free phonetic realization.